PRD-05 · Resume check

Status: Shipped (v0.1.2) · **Updated:** 2026-10-30 · **Design:** DD-05 Resume check

1. Summary

Before an interview there is a screen. Most companies run resumes through an **applicant tracking system (ATS)** that parses the file and ranks it by keywords, and more and more add an **AI screen** that grades fit. Onsite's *Resume check* shows the candidate what those systems see, and every loop starts with it.

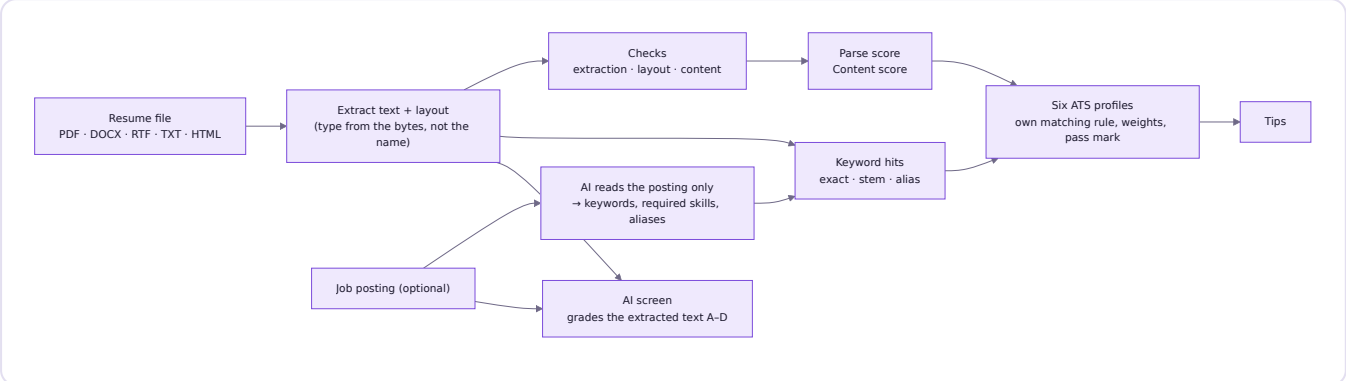
2. User stories

Id	As a candidate I want to…	So that…
ATS-S1	see the text an ATS pulls out of my file	I spot scrambled columns or missing contact details
ATS-S2	know if Workday, Taleo, iCIMS, Greenhouse, Lever or SuccessFactors would pass me	I fix the format before applying
ATS-S3	see which posting keywords I hit and miss	I can tailor honestly
ATS-S4	get an AI recruiter's grade with reasons	I know how a "role fit" model reads me
ATS-S5	have the check run automatically when I start a loop	the interviewer works from the same text the ATS saw

3. What the candidate sees

```
┌──────────────────────────────── Resume check ────────────────────────────────┐
│  ( 86 )  Can an ATS read it?    ( 72 )  Content    ( 64 )  Match to posting  │
│                                                                              │
│  ATS by ATS                                                                  │
│  Workday        61  ✗  "Workday reads two columns as one, mixing lines."     │
│  Taleo          58  ✗  "Taleo often skips table cells."                      │
│  iCIMS          74  ✓                                                        │
│  Greenhouse     71  ✓                                                        │
│  Lever          66  ✓                                                        │
│  SuccessFactors 63  ✗                                                        │
│                                                                              │
│  Keywords  ✓ Java  ✓ Kafka  ✓ PostgreSQL  ✗ Kubernetes  ~ microservice       │
│  Checks    ✓ text layer  ✗ two columns  ✓ contact  ✓ dates  ! 3 pages        │
│  What the ATS sees  ▸ "PRATEESH SULIKERI  Backend Engineer  Java …"          │
│                                                                              │
│  AI screen   Grade B · fit 78                                                │
│   Must-haves: ✓ Java (proven) ✓ Kafka (proven) ~ AWS (claimed) ✗ K8s         │
│   Red flags: none · Level: matches SDE-2                                     │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

4. How the scores are built



- **Everything except the two AI steps is deterministic.** Same file, same posting → same scores.
- **The AI never sees the resume when reading the posting**, and the AI screen sees only the *extracted* text, exactly what an ATS would pass on. That is how it notices scrambled two-column reading order on its own.

The six ATS profiles

ATS	Vendor	Matching	Pass mark	Note shown
Workday	Workday	Exact words	70	Strict parser. Skips page headers and footers.
Taleo	Oracle	Exact words	65	Oldest and most literal. Boolean filters, knock-out questions.
iCIMS	iCIMS	By meaning	60	Most forgiving parser.
Greenhouse	Greenhouse	By meaning	60	Doesn't auto-reject; a person reviews.
Lever	Employ	Word forms	60	No ranking; recruiters search.
SuccessFactors	SAP	Skill taxonomy (aliases count)	65	Textkernel parser.

Checks and the match score are ported from **Resume-Matcher** (Apache-2.0); the six profiles follow **ats-screener** (MIT). See `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md`.

5. Requirements

Id	Requirement	Status
ATS-R1	Accept PDF, .docx, .rtf, UTF-8/16 text and .html. Detect the type from the bytes.	Shipped
ATS-R2	Refuse old .doc, images, .odt/.pages and password PDFs with a plain message. Owner-only-locked PDFs open.	Shipped
ATS-R3	Show the extracted text preview: "what the ATS sees".	Shipped
ATS-R4	Detect: no text layer, garbled glyphs, low text coverage, multiple columns, tables, text boxes, header/footer-only contact info, images, page count, contact details, section headings, date formats.	Shipped
ATS-R5	Score six ATS profiles, each with its own matching strategy, weights and pass mark, plus specific issues ("Workday may cut text after page 2").	Shipped
ATS-R6	With a posting: keyword hits per term (exact / stem / alias), required vs preferred.	Shipped
ATS-R7	AI screen: grade A–D, fit 0–100 tied to the grade, must-haves (proven / claimed / missing), level fit, red flags.	Shipped
ATS-R8	The AI screen never guesses gender, age, nationality or other traits from the name.	Shipped (prompt rule)
ATS-R9	AI results are cached per posting (keywords) and per resume + posting (screen).	Shipped

Id	Requirement	Status
ATS-R10	Starting a loop runs the check first. No resume, or an unreadable file, blocks the loop. The result shows on Get ready.	Shipped
ATS-R11	Offline CLI for testing: `cargo run --example ats_check -- resume.pdf [job.json] [--json]`.	Shipped

6. Honest limits

The six profiles are **simulations** built from public documentation and community testing, not the vendors' code. They are good at catching format problems and keyword gaps. They are not a promise that a real system will pass or reject a resume. The UI should never say otherwise.